OPERATION SPACE

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Hello! We are Operation Space, an organization based in Stony Brook, New York. We are focused on launching a rocket to break the student altitude record of 130,000 feet and hopefully reach the Kármán line, which is considered the border between Earth's atmosphere and outer space. Designing, building and launching a rocket of this magnitude faces a serious financial obstacle. We are raising money in the hopes that our dream of reaching outer space can be achieved.

Outer space has encapsulated the imagination of many individuals; however, the rate of progress in the field to the public has appeared dismal. Recently, advances by private companies have renewed interest in space, but most feel that space is a place only for governments or billionaires. There are a few amateur teams that have reached the Kármán line, but they have been more professional than it might appear, with many team member's full-time jobs focused on the rocket. Our goal is to give students from across the nation the opportunity to work with their other talented peers, and inspire students across the country by showing them that many things they've deemed out of the reach are actually very possible. Currently no student team has reached space. Several institutions such as the University of Southern California and Boston University have designed rockets that have come close, but the concept that a university is backing these projects still creates the impression that you need some sort of large institution's backing to be successful. We are encouraging students that with a good work ethic, serious thought, and creativity, anything is achievable.

Furthermore, our goal is ambitious. We not only hope to reach outer space, but hope to do so before the end of Summer 2018. We are also looking at several experiments that we could take aboard as payload. We're hoping that we can find some experiments that are a bit out of box that more established organizations may shy away from; due to our small size and ambitious mindset, we'd be open to this.

Recently, hackathons have become quite popular with college students and young adults. These hackathons provide an opportunity to create an app or computer program in a 24-48 hour, coffee powered sprint. Students love these hackathons; however, there have been little hackathon-modeled events for physical objects. Our project takes on the feeling of a hackathon with students under a time crunch of just a few months to assemble a rocket to reach space. May, June and the first half of July will be remote work amongst students: designing the rocket, researching components, and ordering parts. We have been fortunate enough to have been granted two free weeks at the former Grumman production facility in Bethpage, New York, the same hanger that the original Lunar Module was built in. We will be using this facility for the last two weeks of July with the entire team being flown in from across the country and working continuously to assemble and test the rocket. We are aiming for a launch in August in a safe location, most probably a desert in the SouthWest United States.

It is incredibly important to us to provide a meaningful opportunity for some of America's brightest young people to work together on a passionate project that will inspire thousands of high school and college students and ignite the child in all adults across the country. We will be filming the entire process, from designing of the rocket to the launch, and condensing it into a short YouTube clip so that as many people as possible can see the possibilities lent by hard work and creativity.

Thank you so much for your support. Together we will inspire the next generation.

Sincerely,
The Operation Space Team